

Introduction

Let me start with a quick question for the class — what are we studying in this course?

...[Audience responds: "Public Speaking"]

Hmm. I'd like you to try that again — we might be forgetting a small but important piece...

Communication and Public Speaking. There it is.

And it's that word — communication — that sometimes gets completely overshadowed by the performance of public speaking.

But here's the thing: most of the situations we will face in life aren't a podium in front of an audience. They're a workplace. A team meeting. A group project at midnight before a deadline. Places where how you communicate with the people around you directly determines whether something succeeds or falls apart.

Communication, when applied effectively, isn't just a way to get along with your coworkers. It is a foundational skill that elevates an organization to a level where it can solve every problem that is solvable.

You're probably familiar with Steve Jobs. In the early 1980s, while Apple was still taking shape, Jobs had a vision — that personal computers belonged in every home. But vision alone doesn't build a company. In a mid-1980s interview, he said:

"That's what leadership is: having a vision, being able to articulate that so the people around you can understand it, and getting a consensus on a common vision."

While Apple hadn't yet become the giant we know today, Jobs' ability to align his engineers, his designers, and his marketing team around one shared idea kept the whole ship afloat — while other companies were still stuck in boardrooms debating what to put on a brochure.

That's what great communication does. As Simon Sinek puts it: "Leadership is a way of thinking, a way of acting, and most importantly, a way of communicating."

And if you want to understand how that communication actually works inside an organization, Peter Drucker gives us the sharpest lens: "The most important thing in communication is hearing what isn't said."

Today, we're going to explore exactly that — the invisible architecture of organizational communication, through three foundational ideas: how organizations are structured, how communication networks form within them, and how they connect to the world outside their walls.